



Brokerage Accounts

A brokerage account is an investment account at a registered brokerage firm that allows you to buy and sell a variety of investment products such as [stocks \(/introduction-investing/investing-basics/investment-products/stocks\)](#) , [bonds \(/introduction-investing/investing-basics/investment-products/bonds-or-fixed-income-products/bonds\)](#) , [mutual funds \(/introduction-investing/investing-basics/investment-products/mutual-funds-and-exchange-traded-funds-etfs/mutual-funds\)](#) , and [exchange-traded funds \(ETFs\) \(/introduction-investing/investing-basics/investment-products/mutual-funds-and-exchange-traded-2\)](#) . The two general types of brokerage accounts are: cash accounts ([/introduction-investing/general-resources/news-alerts/alerts-bulletins/investor-bulletins/updated-9](#)) (a brokerage account in which you must pay the full amount for any securities purchased) and margin accounts ([/introduction-investing/general-resources/news-alerts/alerts-bulletins/investor-bulletins-29](#)) (a type of brokerage account in which your brokerage firm lends you cash, using the account as collateral, to purchase securities).

Learn more ([/introduction-investing/general-resources/news-alerts/alerts-bulletins/investor-bulletins-43](#)) .